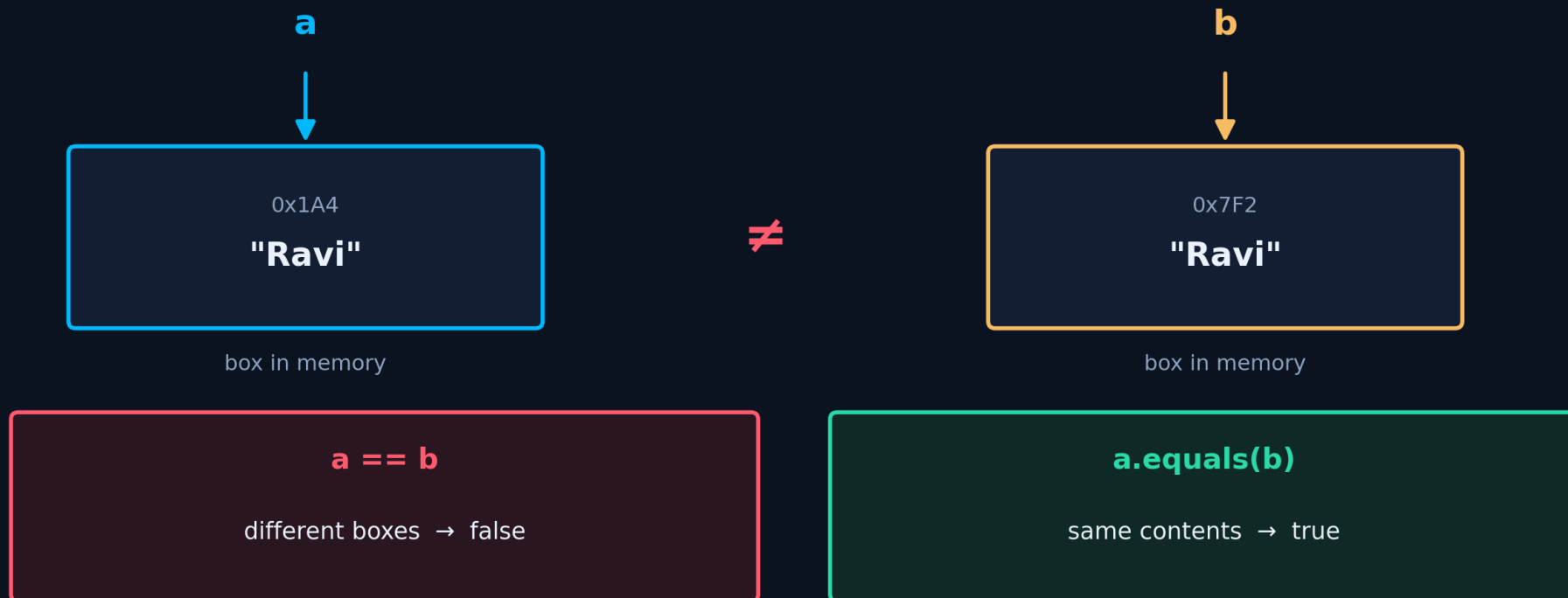


These two Strings are **equal** but not equal

TWO NAMES THAT LOOK THE SAME

```
String a = "Ravi"; String b = new String("Ravi");
```



- 1 ``==`` asks: are these the **same box in memory**?
- 2 ``.equals()`` asks: do they **hold the same value**?
- 3 Small strings get reused by the JVM, so ``==`` sometimes works — by accident.

REMEMBER THIS

Use `.equals()` for values. The times `==` works are luck, not logic.